



July 23, 2026

City of Opa-locka

Public Works Department
Attn: Mr. Airia Austin, Public Works Director
Mr. Owen Carney, Superintendent
780 Fisherman Street
Opa-locka, FL 33054

Miami-Dade Water and Sewer Department

Billing and collecting on behalf of the City of Opa-locka
Attn: High-Bill Investigation and Customer Advocacy

Re: Formal Dispute of Water and Sewer Charges

Account No. 2745714336 | Meter No. 61302354
13200 Alexandria Drive, Building 8, Opa-locka, FL 33054
Folio No. 08-2128-007-0210

Dear Mr. Austin and Members of the Water and Sewer Team:

We are writing on behalf of the ownership of Glorieta Gardens to formally dispute the past-due balance on the account referenced above. We have reviewed the account, the two most recent statements, and the Department's own meter records. Based on that review, we have confirmed that a substantial portion of the balance is based on estimated water usage that did not occur. We respectfully request that the account be corrected.

Summary of the Disputed Charges

The figures below are taken directly from the Department's statements and meter records:

1. Total account balance as of the June 11, 2026 statement: **\$113,874.41**.
2. Balance created by the retroactive re-billing dated March 30, 2026: **\$95,017.57**.
3. Estimated usage applied: approximately **216,000 gallons per month**, or about 7,200 gallons per day.
4. Period covered by the estimate: approximately **22 consecutive months**, beginning April 2024.

We do not dispute charges for water and sewer service that the meter actually recorded. Our dispute is limited to the estimated charges described below.

Background

Building 8 was condemned and ordered vacated by the City of Opa-locka in August 2023. The residents were relocated, and the building remained unoccupied while it was rehabilitated throughout 2024, including work on the underground water and sewer lines. The red-tag status was not lifted until December 2024, and the building was not reoccupied until early 2025. For nearly all of 2024 there were no residents at the property and no ordinary water use. We have validated that the property was vacant during this period.



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Basis for the Dispute

We do not believe the disputed amount is owed, for the following reasons:

1. **The charges are based on estimates, not actual meter readings.** The Department's own meter-read history identifies nearly every month in the re-billed period as an office estimate rather than an actual reading.
2. **The meter of record registered no usage.** Up through the meter changeover in April 2024, the preceding meter showed a frozen register and zero consumption, with readings marked as “no read” and “do not use.” Water that never passed through the meter cannot properly be billed.
3. **The estimated usage was applied to a building the City had condemned and ordered vacant.** Usage of approximately 216,000 gallons per month, or roughly 7,200 gallons per day, was not possible in a building that was empty and under construction.
4. **The account was paid current.** The disputed balance did not arise from unpaid service. It was created in a single re-billing dated March 30, 2026 that reached back nearly two years and replaced statements that had already been issued and paid.
5. **The charges have not been substantiated.** To support charges that are disputed, actual meter data is required. Estimated readings for a vacant building whose meter recorded zero do not meet that standard.

Requested Resolution

We respectfully request that the Department:

1. Correct the account by removing the estimated charges and, if appropriate, re-bill only on the basis of actual meter readings;
2. Suspend the past-due status, the late charge, and any discontinuance of service on the disputed amount while this matter is reviewed;
3. Provide the records supporting the charges, including the meter-change work order with the installation date and starting register reading, the actual meter readings and status codes for April through December 2024, the written basis for the estimate, and the high-bill findings letter dated May 14, 2026; and
4. Permit a payment arrangement for the undisputed current charges so the account remains in good standing.

We are raising this matter in good faith and are fully prepared to pay promptly for any service the meter actually recorded. We would appreciate a written response identifying the individual assigned to this matter. Thank you for your time and your assistance.

Respectfully,

Chris Sullivan
Authorized Representative
Glorieta Partners, Ltd
c/o R4 GGOL GP LLC



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